



CONSTITUTION

**INSTITUTE FOR SUSTAINABLE
DEVELOPMENT OF AFRICA (ISSTA)**

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1.0 LEGAL STATUS AND LOCATION OF ISSTA

ISSTA will be established as a Non-State Agency in Uganda in the nature of a Non-Governmental Organization as well as a Private Sector Company limited by Guarantee and not by shareholding. ISSTA will be headquartered in Uganda - also open to collaborations across Africa but subject to national laws and regulations in the relevant countries or regions. ISSTA shall work within legal and regulatory frameworks pertaining to sectors and geographical locations of its direct and indirect interventions. ISSTA shall have a website, P.O.Box address; official logo, and location.

2.0 ISSTA MOTIVATION

The strife for sustainable development across the world is historical but most recently, after the expiry of the Millennium Development Goals in 2015, leaders from 193 UN member states agreed on new development goals otherwise referred to as Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). SDGs are 17 with achievement expected in 15 years i.e. the 2030 sustainable development agenda. This agenda builds on the Millennium Development Goals and completes what the (MDGs) did not achieve

The Agenda has 17 Sustainable Development Goals and 169 targets, which are integrated and indivisible and balance the three dimensions of sustainable development i.e. the economic, social and environment. The SDGs include: Ending Extreme Poverty; Ending hunger; Ensuring Good Health and Well-being; Ensuring Quality Education; Ensuring Gender Equality; Ensuring Clean Water and Sanitation; Ensuring Affordable and Clean Energy; Ensuring Decent Work and Economic Growth; Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure; Ensuring Reduced Inequalities among people, communities, classes of persons and nations; Ensuring Sustainable Cities and Communities; Ensuring Responsible Consumption and Production; Climate Action; Prudent management of Life Below Water and Life on Land; Ensuring Peace Justice and Strong Institutions; and Ensuring Partnerships For The Goals achievement.

ISSTA passion towards Sustainable Development is drawn from the above mentioned United Nation Mission as well as other national, regional and international frameworks to advance all areas of sustainable development in Uganda and other countries of Africa but in partnership with stakeholders across the world.

3.0 ISSTA MISSION, VISION, VALUES, AND OBJECTIVES

3.1 ISSTA Vision and Mission

3.1.1 Vision: A world prospering in Sustainable Development, poised to cater for present and future generations

3.1.2 Mission: Contributing to Sustainable Development of Uganda and Africa through local, regional, continental and global frameworks

The mission is pursued on four dimensions namely: economic dimension; social and societal dimension; environmental and ecological dimension; and good governance.

3.2 Values: ISSTA embraces the values of: Transparency and Accountability; Fairness, Equity and Non-discrimination particularly in reference to minorities, sex/gender, age, vulnerable groups, race, ethnicity, and nationality; Solidarity and Team Work; Respect for national sovereignties and the power of networking for progress; Democracy and Human Rights Observance including Gender Rights; Youth Empowerment; and Shared Responsibility – which actually the most fundamental premise upon which ISSTA bases its work in joint contribution with other development stakeholders of Africa to fast track all sustainable development facets.

3.3 Key objective: To monitor and support achievement of the United Nations Sustainable Development Agenda in Uganda

3.3.1 Specific Objectives (SO):

(SO_a) Using a collaborative approach, periodically research on the trend of Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)/Sustainable Development in Uganda and other Africa countries to identify strong intervention points to fast track progress

- (SO_b)** Using a collaborative approach, advocate and work in partnership with national, regional and global stakeholders for achievement of SDGs/Sustainable Development for Uganda and all Africa basing all work on evidence based information
- (SO_c)** Using a collaborative approach, empower citizens with knowledge, skills, equipment and other inputs, organizational capacities towards the promotion of sustainable development outcomes including the promotion of social accountability

4.0 FUNDING, TAXATION AND ACTIVITIES OF ISSTA

Funding for ISSTA activities will be sourced from membership fees, social, cultural and economic activity, and local and international philanthropists. Activities will include but not limited to non-profit and for-profit: support to agricultural sectors and enterprise; health, education, social protection, water and sanitation sectors support including direct physical inputs and or structural investments in sectors i.e. schools, hospitals, boreholes etc. - contributing to sector progress through enhancing accountability and making inputs to policy reviews and implementation approaches; and support to industrialization and cooperative initiatives. ISSTA will honor all relevant taxes, rents, rates, fees, insurance and transportation costs, interest charges and other such costs but will also pursue rebates applicable to charity work in any sector and geographical location.

5.0 ISSTA STRATEGIC PLANNING IMPLEMENTATION AND REVIEW PROCESSES

ISSTA will operate on the basis of five (5) year strategic plans which will be reviewed through mid-term and end term reviews. The review process should inform the designing of goals, objectives and activities for integration into plans for the way forward towards improved performance on results achievement and optimum resources utilization. Other than the strategic plan, any independent programme requiring independent review as per stakeholder/philanthropist agreements should be

reviewed accordingly. The above means that towards the end of the five years, spearheaded by the Chief Accounting Officer, the secretariat, membership representatives and or board of directors have to convene at a retreat physically far away from the workplace for necessary number of days - say about 4 - 7 days and chart out the way forwards for the next 5 years. This is useful for maximum concentration and creative thinking. However, this can only be successfully done if the running programme is expertly reviewed by competent consultants. Following this is that the same consultants having reviewed the current strategic plan - should also be able to provide resource persons expertise in drawing the inclusive participation of the ISSTA team in successfully charting out a feasible way forward. The new 5 year strategic plans should be finalized within a fortnight of completion of the retreat and should be part of the expert's assignment and final payment terms as stipulated in the Terms of Reference (ToRs). The strategic plan should be complete with a well-articulated narrative, 5 year and annual work plans, 5 year and annual budgets, logical framework clearly stipulating the vision, mission, key and specific objectives as well as a list of specific activities under each specific objective, overarching monitoring and evaluation plans, problem tree, stakeholder map and management matrix, indicator tracking tables, risk scale, risk log, risks and mitigation plan and any other additional tools found economic, necessary, non-duplicating and feasible.

6.0 ISSTA MEMBERSHIP, ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND ELECTIONS

6.1 Membership

It is acceptable for Ordinary, Association and Associate membership to exist and ISSTA embraces a free entry and exit policy so long as a member has fulfilled the entry and exit requirements. Members are free to exit ISSTA at will but membership fees are not refundable.

6.1.1 Ordinary membership

It is open to persons exhibiting sufficient passion to participate and contribute to Sustainable Development at individual, family, community, national and global levels.

Subscription fees per person per annum are flexible but a minimum of USD20 or the equivalent per year. Ordinary membership provides for individual households and community members. It is from the ordinary membership and at an Annual General Meeting (AGM) that a Board of Directors (BoD) will be democratically elected and serve a period of seven years. The BoDs is reserved the right to pass disciplinary or reward judgment towards members with respect to their conduct.

6.1.2 Association membership

It is open to likeminded Organizations that may be local, regional or international but whose association holds a promise of Value Addition (VA). Annual membership fees will be a minimum of USD100 and membership is subject to sanctioning and approval by the ISSTA secretariat represented by the ISSTA Chief Executive Officer and approved by the ISSTA Board of Directors but subject to review after every year including a veto option. Association Membership does not carry voting rights but are eligible to collaborations also in the form of consultancy for and with ISSTA including acceptance to attend AGMs.

6.1.3 Associate Membership

It is open to experts who may be consultants in the development arena and open to nationals of any country so long as they hold a promise of value addition. Their work and activities' with ISSTA will be defined by MoUs. Actually all consultants engaged to perform duties at ISSTA will be encouraged to subscribe to Associate Membership at a rate of USD500 per annum with a review of the validity of membership after every one year. As a matter of fact, Consultants with Associate Membership will take precedence in the competition for consultancy work so long as the consultants possess the necessary credentials. Associate membership does not carry voting rights but is eligible to attend the AGM

All categories of members will be entitled to receive free hard and or soft copies of periodicals.

6.2 Annual General Meeting

The secretariat will schedule a tentative date during the month of November or December but in any case before the closure of annual business and communicate to

the Board Chairperson in order to reach a final decision. After a date is agreed, the secretariat will arrange for the event by way of sending out invitations to all members inclusive of an agenda for the day. The generic format of the agenda will be as below:

Agenda for ISSTA Meeting Slated forDD/MM/YR at
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1. Opening Prayer
2. Communication from the Chair
3. Communication from Board Secretary on program activities update
4. Issues of Arising
5. Generic Action Planning and Way Forward
6. BoD Election (In case it is a voting year)
7. Closing Prayer

The secretariat will identify and contract an experienced moderator/paid resource person to manage the agenda items of the AGM. Under membership categories above, it is mentioned which members have voting rights and this should be observed.

7.0 Governance

7.1 Board of Directors (BoDs) and Executive Director of ISSTA

BoDs of ISSTA shall be the highest governing organ of ISSTA and responsible for policy making and oversight. It will normally comprise of 6 democratically elected members who will serve the thematic areas of finance, programs, human resources, administration policy and oversight. The seventh member of the Board will be the CEO – also the Executive Director of ISSTA who will serve as Permanent Secretary (PS). PS is also the Chief Accounting Officer of the Organization. Board Members are not entitled to regular emoluments but to a sitting allowance whenever a sitting takes place. The magnitude, regularity or promptness of the emolument will be decided by the secretariat as and when funds allow. Board members are free to exit ISSTA in lieu

of 3 months written advance notice so that ISSTA can prepare a replacement subject to confirmation or replacement by the next AGM.

Substantive Board members will be those who have successfully raised operations and development funds for ISSTA – in fact they will be entitled to membership without payment of membership fees and 2 terms of service on the Board of Directors each being 7 years. They will also be entitled to represent ISSTA at National, Regional and International fora but at the invitation of the ISSTA secretariat.

All BoDs will be enlisted on the ISSTA website along with their portraits, credentials and contributions. They will also be entitled to receive free hard and or soft copies of periodicals.

7.2. ISSTA Secretariat

ISSTA will be operated by a secretariat on a day to day basis and accountable to the Executive Director. A general hierarchical line-up of capable, correct mindset officers from either gender will be as below. The secretariat will be responsible for developing an organizational chart with respect to the arrangement below. The secretariat can propose amendments provided they are characterized by good-will and feasibility towards enhanced workflow and productivity:

- (i) Executive Director – 1
- (ii) Head of Programmes – 1
- (iii) Internal Auditor – 1
- (iv) Head of Finance and Administration – 1
- (v) Programme Managers -11
- (vi) IT Officer – 1
- (vii) Documentation Officers – 2
- (viii) Finance Manager -1
- (ix) Administration and Human Resource Manager – 1
- (x) Monitoring and Evaluation Officer – 1
- (xi) Finance Officers – 2
- (xii) Internal Audit Officers – 2

(xiii) Administrative and Human resource officer – 1

(xiv) Programme Assistants -16

(xv) Accounts Assistants – 4.

(xvi) Administrative Assistants and Drivers -6

The secretariat is left the will to make adjustments in the organizational chart and office bearer titles as well as reporting format so long as it ensures enhanced smooth work flow and improved group dynamics towards result areas achievement

7.3 External Financial Audits, Evaluations and Administrative Audits

External financial audits will be annual and auditors will be identified by the secretariat in a transparent procurement process and approved by the BoDs. Program evaluations will be of a mid-term and end-term nature – falling due as and when necessary – depending on each specific programme cycle. Administrative Audits will be carried out after every seven year term – commensurate to a BoD term.

7.4 Resources Management

Manuals will be developed for resources management pertaining to human, financial and assets management. After approval by the ISSTA Chief Executive Officer, the manuals will become operational but will have to be presented at the earliest Board meeting for comments, which when agreed as necessary for inclusion, the secretariat will integrate the comments into the manuals.

7.5 Recruitments, Placements, Disciplinary Actions

The recruitments process will be handled internally at the secretariat by Human Resources personnel but in consultation with a board member responsible for human resources. It will also be acceptable to involve the services of a contracted human resources consultant. This arrangement will also be instrumental in initiating the human resources manual.

7.5.1 Salaries, Contractual Payments and Allowances

Staff will be paid the above on a monthly or as contracted but subject to availability of funding. Rates will be decided by the secretariat i.e. the Executive Director depending on availability funds and donor agreements and budgets.

7.5.2 Social Security and Taxes

ISSTA will pay Social Security to the National Social Security Fund (NSSF) for fulltime staff as well as taxes due on Salary and other payments as per laws and regulations of Uganda.

7.6 Procurement Processes

ISSTA will own, hire and or manage assets of a varied nature including Land, Labor, Capital and Entrepreneurship. However procurements are a known route through which large resources can leak out of an organization and as such, ISSTA will utilize a regulated process for all levels procurements. Procedures will be spelt out in ISSTA Human Resource, Finance and Administration manuals that should be compiled by the secretariat and approved by the board before operationalization. The above notwithstanding, a streamlined procurements process will be the direct responsibility of the secretariat, basically managed by the Chief Accounting Officer, Chief Accountant, Procurements committee and other officers drawn from finance and administration teams. In the course of all associated work, the principles of accountability, transparency, team work and value for money will be upheld.

7.7 Publicity, Networking and Collaboration

ISSTA will utilize the publicity, networking and collaboration lever to fast track it's mutually beneficial agenda. ISSTA's value of shared responsibility will enable it to utilize the broad sustainable development stakeholder-ship and partner with it in advancement towards individual and collective stakeholder achievements. ISSTA will be very happy working with: philanthropists; continental and regional farmers associations; corporate social responsibility institutions/agencies and product standards bodies; local and central governments; Faith Based Organizations (FBOs); Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) of a local, regional, continental and international nature; world governments; regional and continental economic cooperation bodies; private sector companies; banks, financial institutions and their agencies; and cooperative movements including international cooperative alliance. ISSTA will publicize its existence, activities, achievements like case change stories and

opportunities on its website and in the various media platforms available. It will also utilize media and publicity for prominence as well as solicit for funding support. In order to foster publicity, networking and collaboration, Memorandum of Understanding (MoUs) will be drawn and signed with support from legal persons recognized in the relevant country, regional or global contexts.

7.8 Local Content

ISSTA is an indigenous organization headquartered in Uganda with its key programmes focused on working with in-country and external stakeholders which include local and central government ministries, departments and agencies with special focus on ordinary citizenry to impact sustainable development outcomes on indigenous individuals across sectors much on top of the agenda. Local citizens will benefit from direct employment, and service contracts open to the most competent. ISSTA respects all national, regional and international covenants like the SDGs covenant that Uganda endorsed with other United Nations (UN) members in 2015 – this also includes arrangements under East African Community (EAC), African Union (AU), South African Development Corporation (SADC), and African Continent Free Trade Area (ACFTA). Additionally, ISSTA will provide human development opportunities to national including youth and women in a bid to enhance their economic productivity and labor market place competitiveness. Such exposure includes ISSTA internship opportunities to national, regional and international students, researchers and development workers. However, ISSTA secretariat will always sanction internship applications to ensure that mutual benefit to ISSTA and the individual are always maintained.

7.9 Risks, Insurance, Fires, Theft and Security

ISSTA will hedge against various risks through insurance contracts with reputable actors facing resources i.e. fixed, human and financial assets. Staff travelling abroad will be covered by travel, medical and other relevant insurance policy to the context at the time. Fulltime staff will ideally be covered by group and medical insurance for up to own selected 4 to 5 members of their households but largely dependent on the

terms and conditions of the health insurance service provider. ISSTA will also invest in social security for fulltime staff according the law of the land. Assets like motor vehicles, electronic equipment and other assets will also be insured using policies agreed upon with the insuring companies. Insurance against risk will be applied for any other relevant ISSTA matter.

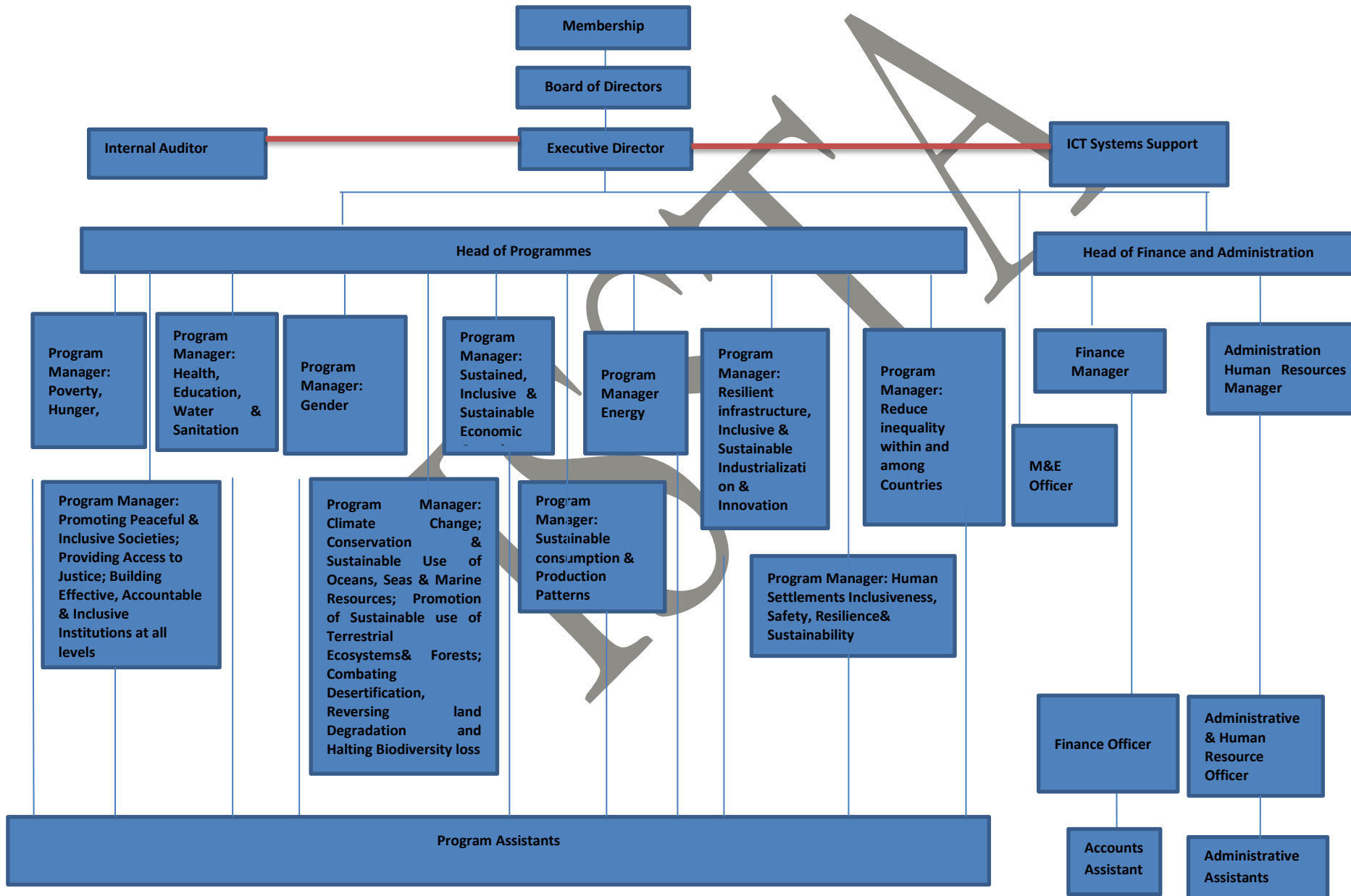
ISSTA will on a day to day basis ensure security at its premises by among other measures, installing security cameras in and around its premises coupled with the hiring of security firms to support 24 hours security work. Staff will be trained on how to prevent and at the same time respond to office/premise fires including fire-fighting. Matters of theft will be investigated by the security team using gadgets and skills, followed by appropriate corrective action.

7.10 Life Expectancy of ISSTA

It is not limited because sustainable development is a long term goal pursued from generation to generation. Thus ISSTA will be passed on from one generation to the next in pursuit of what is and what will be referred to as Sustainable Development.



Appendix I: ISSTA (Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa) Governance Structure



ISSTA